

Hackathon Kit

Everything the team needs to pitch, demo, and defend AaaS at the table.

Positioning: Odisha-first, Odia-first. The live demo is in Odia, the target pilots are in Odisha, and the state's 5T / Mo Sarkar programmes are the policy anchor. The technical plan for Odia (typography, speech stack, dyslexia rules, pilot partners) is in [docs/odia-language-strategy.md](#) — read that before the first pitch.

File	Read it when
PITCH.md	Preparing what you will <i>say</i> . Has 15-second, 60-second, 3-minute, 5-minute variants.
DEMO_SCRIPT.md	Preparing what you will <i>show</i> . Scene-by-scene narration and fallbacks.
JUDGE_QA.md	Preparing what you will <i>answer</i> . 25+ anticipated questions with crisp replies.
PRESENTER_BRIEF.md	Carry in your pocket. The one-pager with numbers, phrases, and safe moves.
BOOTH_CHECKLIST.md	The day-of checklist. Pack list, setup order, fallback triggers.

How to use this kit in the week before the hackathon

Day -7. Read all five files. Rehearse the 60-second pitch aloud. **Day -5.** Run the full demo end-to-end. Time it. Run it again. **Day -3.** Rehearse with someone outside the team watching. Ask what confused them. **Day -2.** Record the demo as a video fallback. Print the brief and checklist. **Day -1.** Pack, sleep, don't add features. **Day 0.** Work the checklist. Trust the prep.

Principles under all of this

1. **Honesty beats hype.** Judges have seen every vaporware pitch. A smaller, real demo wins.
2. **Speak to the human before the tech.** Priya, Arun, Meera before IndicTrans2, Whisper, Piper.
3. **Design the demo around what cannot fail.** If one layer of the stack is flaky, don't demo it.
4. **Every conversation ends with an ask.** Without an ask, a good conversation produces nothing.

AaaS — Pitch Playbook

Team: SUBARNAREKHA **Project:** Accessibility as a Service — Built for Odisha, designed for every Indian public institution. **One-liner:** *The UPI of accessibility — an open, shared, Odia-first layer any public institution can plug into.*

Pick the variant that fits the slot you get. Each one is written to be spoken, not read. Practise aloud until you hit the time.

The 15-second hook (judge walks up to the booth)

"Every public-university website in Odisha fails accessibility. We built an open-source layer — design system, Odia-first voice AI, and a compliance scorecard — that any institution can deploy in an afternoon. Think UPI, but for accessibility. Odisha first, India next."

Pause. Let them ask the next question. Don't pitch past the hook.

The 60-second pitch (elevator / intro round)

Problem. Odisha has over 21 lakh persons with disabilities and 42 million Odia speakers. Yet nearly every public-institution portal in the state — admissions, scholarships, pensions, exams — is built English-first, keyboard-hostile, and screen-reader-broken. Each of Odisha's 15+ state universities and 200+ BPUT-affiliated colleges tries to fix it alone, badly or not at all.

Insight. Accessibility shouldn't be 200 separate projects. It should be shared digital public infrastructure — the way UPI is for payments and DigiLocker is for documents. And for Odisha's citizens, it should start in Odia.

Solution. AaaS is three things in one open-source stack:

1. A **design system** where every component ships WCAG 2.2 AA out of the box — AAA colour contrast, 44 px touch targets, keyboard-first, screen-reader-clean, with Noto Sans Oriya and Odia-aware typography bundled in.
2. An **assistive services layer** — on-prem Odia voice (AI4Bharat IndicConformer + Indic-TTS), translation (IndicTrans2), captions, dyslexia-friendly reading mode tuned for Odia script — that users toggle on demand.
3. A **compliance scorecard** any institution can run on their own site and watch trend upward over time.

Status. Foundations are live today — design system, accessibility test harness, dev stack, threat model, DPDP data-flow, Odia language strategy document. Apache-2.0. On-prem-capable, so data

never leaves Odisha.

Ask. We want the minimum viable *public* accessibility layer. Adopt it for one Odisha institution. Fork it. Fund it. Then watch the rest of the state follow.

The 3-minute pitch (booth / panel round)

Open — the human. *[Look up, make eye contact before starting.]* Picture Priyanka. She's blind, she's in Class 12 in Puri, she speaks only Odia, and next week she has to fill an online admission form for Utkal University. Today, that form defeats her — the labels aren't linked to inputs, the captcha is image-only, the page is in English, the error messages flash red and disappear. She asks her brother to fill it for her. Half of Odisha's disabled students end up doing the same.

The scale. Odisha has over 21 lakh persons with disabilities by the conservative 2011 Census — the real number is higher. It has 15+ state universities, 200+ BPUT-affiliated colleges, 62,000+ schools, and a unified citizen-services stack run by OCAC. Every one of them legally owes accessibility under the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act and the state's own 5T mandate — and almost none of them deliver it.

Why this keeps failing. Because we've been treating accessibility as a per-project checkbox. Each institution hires a vendor, bolts on an "overlay" widget, ticks the box, moves on. Overlays are widely criticised by the disability community for not actually fixing anything. And no one measures the outcome.

Our thesis. Accessibility has to become *infrastructure*, not *remediation*. Three pieces:

1. `@aaas/ui` — a React design system. Priyanka's admission form, built with our `Button` and `Input` and `Form` components, is accessible at commit time — not after a QA cycle. Contrast is AAA by default. Every focus state is visible. Noto Sans Oriya is bundled, line-height is tuned for Odia conjuncts, dyslexia mode flips one attribute.
2. `@aaas/a11y-test` — a harness that any institution runs against their own deployment. Machine-readable report per WCAG 2.2 criterion. Shows up in CI on every pull request.
3. **The assistive widget** — a small floating button. Priyanka taps it, speaks in Odia, and her voice drives the form. AI4Bharat IndicConformer for Odia speech, IndicTrans2 for translation into English for downstream processing, AI4Bharat Indic-TTS for the Odia voice back. All on-prem. All open weights. DPDP-compliant because data never leaves the institution's VM — the institution's VM being, in this case, OCAC's data centre in Bhubaneswar.

Demo tease. *[Gesture to laptop.]* I'll show you Priyanka, Arun — who's dyslexic — and Meera, who's Deaf, all three Odia speakers, using the same portal in three very different ways. 90 seconds.

Close. We're calling the project SUBARNAREKHA — after the river that flows through Jharkhand and Bengal and empties into the Bay of Bengal at Odisha's Balasore coast. Subarna means gold; Rekha

means streak. The river carries gold downstream to everyone on its banks. That's the intent. Accessibility shouldn't belong to whoever hires the best vendor. It should belong to every Odia speaker, and then to every Indian.

The 5-minute pitch (main stage / final round)

Use the 3-minute pitch, and after "DPDP-compliant because data never leaves the institution's VM", insert:

The technical bet. We chose three non-obvious things.

One — we're not a widget-only play. Widgets treat broken HTML as a given and patch around it. That's why the a11y community calls them snake oil. We ship the design system *and* the assistive services, so institutions who use our components never need remediation, and institutions who can't rewrite yet still get something useful.

Two — we're on-prem first. Every other accessibility SaaS is a cloud tenant with your users' speech and reading patterns on someone else's servers. Under DPDP, for a public institution that's a liability. Our reference deployment runs Whisper, Piper, and IndicTrans2 on a single GPU node inside the institution's own data centre.

Three — Odia is not an afterthought, and neither are the other Indian languages that follow. Most global accessibility tooling treats Hindi as a translation target and everything else as "other". We're treating **Odia as the primary reference language**, and 11 other Indian languages as first-class input on the same rails. The voice models are fine-tuned on IndicCorp. The fonts ship with Noto Sans Oriya, Devanagari, Tamil, Bengali. The dyslexia stack has Odia-specific conjunct-safe rules — you cannot just set `letter-spacing: 0.12em` on Odia text, it breaks conjuncts. We do the work global tooling skips.

What we've shipped so far. *[Name only what is actually built at demo time — honesty builds trust with judges who've heard too much vaporware.]*

What's next. Phase 1 is multi-tenant auth and the API gateway. Phase 2 is the embed widget. Phase 3 is the Indic AI services. We have a realistic path to all of it — we've already stood up the dev stack, and the threat model, DPDP flow, and WCAG acceptance checklist are written and tracked in the repo.

The ask. Three things, in order of how much you can help: (1) pilot this at one Odisha institution you have influence in — Utkal, IIT Bhubaneswar, NIT Rourkela, OUAT, or an OCAC-run portal; (2) connect us to the Odisha IT Dept or the 5T cell in the Chief Minister's Office; (3) contribute upstream. Apache-2.0, repo link on the booth card.

Close. The cost of building accessibility once, well, and sharing it, is less than the cost of 600 institutions each failing at it separately. That's our one-line case. Thank you.

Taglines (pick one, stay consistent all weekend)

- **The UPI of accessibility** — Odisha first, India next. *(use with govt / 5T / infrastructure-minded audience)*
 - **Accessibility, not an afterthought. Odia, not a translation target.** *(use with designers, language activists, academics)*
 - **One public layer. Two hundred campuses in Odisha. Forty-two million Odia speakers.** *(use with scale-minded funders)*
 - **Built into the component, not bolted onto the page.** *(use when distinguishing from overlays)*
 - **ଓଡ଼ିଶା ପାଇଁ, ଓଡ଼ିଶା ଠାରୁ।** *(Odisha paiñ, Odisha tharun. — “For Odisha, from Odisha.” — use to open Odia-speaking audiences.)*
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Phrases to use

- “Digital public infrastructure” — not “SaaS platform”
- “Odia-first, Indian-public-institution-first” — not just “multilingual”
- “Assistive services layer” or “augmentation widget” — never “overlay” (it’s a slur in the a11y community)
- “Aligned with 5T and Mo Sarkar” — any time you’re talking to Odisha govt audience
- “On-prem at OCAC’s data centre” — more concrete than “on-prem” alone
- “Open source, Apache-2.0” — say it early, it changes the room

Phrases to avoid

- “AI-powered” as a standalone claim — always name the model
 - “Solves accessibility” — we enable it, we don’t solve it
 - “Disabled people” in generic voice — use “people with disabilities” or specific communities (blind, Deaf, dyslexic)
 - “Fixes bad websites” — we replace bad patterns, not paper over them
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Numbers to know cold

Odisha-specific

- **42 million+** Odia speakers (L1 + L2 worldwide; ~37.5M L1 per 2011 Census)
- **21 lakh+** persons with disabilities in Odisha (2011 Census — undercounted)

- **4.65 crore** Odisha population
- **15+** state universities, **200+** BPUT-affiliated colleges, **62,000+** schools
- **6th classical language** of India — Odia, declared 2014
- **5T + Mo Sarkar** are the state's digital-service mandates we align with

India-wide context

- **60 million+** Indians with disabilities (conservative — WHO's 16% estimate puts it higher)
- **22** scheduled languages in the Constitution; we target **12** in Phase 3, **Odia first**

Platform

- **WCAG 2.2 AA** is our compliance floor; **AAA** for colour contrast specifically
- **44 px** minimum touch target (WCAG 2.5.8)
- **≥1.7** line-height for Odia text (vs 1.5 for Latin)
- **Apache-2.0** license
- **Zero** user data leaves the tenant's infrastructure in our reference deployment

AaaS — Demo Script

The live demo is the single most important thing judges remember. This script exists so the presenter can do it under pressure, with background noise, with a dodgy projector, and with one hand holding a water bottle.

Two tracks are documented. Pick one on the morning of the demo based on what is actually shipped and stable at that point. Never attempt the Full-Vision track if Phase 3 AI services are flaky — a broken demo kills the pitch. The Foundation track is honest, short, and wins on substance.

Track choice (decide the morning of the event)

Track	Requires	Length	When to pick
Full-Vision	Phase 0 + widget + at least one working Indic AI service	5–7 min	Everything above is stable across 3 consecutive rehearsals
Foundation	Phase 0 only	3–4 min	Any AI service has failed in rehearsal today

If in doubt, pick Foundation. A clean, honest demo of real infrastructure beats a broken demo of promised AI every time.

Track A — Full-Vision Demo (5–7 minutes)

Setup before judges arrive

1. Laptop plugged in, 100% battery, airplane mode off, all notifications silenced.
2. Two browser windows side by side:
 - **Left:** `https://utkal-university.aaas.local/admissions` — the seeded Odisha demo tenant, Odia default locale.
 - **Right:** `https://utkal-university.aaas.local/admin` — the compliance dashboard, already logged in.
3. A third tab, hidden, pointing at a **recorded screen capture of a successful run**. This is your insurance policy. See the Fallback section.
4. External microphone plugged in and tested. The on-laptop mic struggles with booth noise.
5. One headphone bud in your own ear — a judge may want to listen to the TTS output privately.
6. Water, throat spray, business card / QR code holder on the table.

Scene 1 — The baseline (30 seconds)

Open on the admissions form, scrolled to the top. Page is in English, as most Odisha state-university sites are.

"This is Utkal University's admissions portal — realistic, it looks like most Odisha state-university sites today. English-first, dense, keyboard-hostile. Let's see what accessibility looks like for three Odia-speaking students trying to use it."

Scroll down the form once. Don't over-explain. Let the density of the form speak for itself.

Scene 2 — Priyanka, blind applicant, Odia speaker (90 seconds)

Click the floating AaaS button, bottom-right. Page switches to Odia-labelled variant — Noto Sans Oriya renders crisply.

"Priyanka is blind. She's from Puri. She speaks only Odia. She taps this button and talks to the form."

Hold the mic up, speak naturally in Odia:

"ନମସ୍କାର, ମୁଁ ବି.କମ୍ ପାଇଁ ଆବେଦନ କରିବାକୁ ଚାହୁଁଛି।" (Transliterated: Namaskar, mun B.Com pain abedan kariba-ku chahunchhi.) (Translation: "Hello, I want to apply for B.Com.)"

Pause — let the on-screen transcription appear in Odia script. Let the Odia voice reply play.

Narrate over the response:

"Behind this, three models are running on-prem. AI4Bharat's IndicConformer for her Odia speech — roughly 15% word-error rate, much better than Whisper for Odia. IndicTrans2 if we need to bridge to English for downstream processing. AI4Bharat's Indic-TTS for the Odia voice back. Zero user data leaves this laptop. In production, it lives at OCAC's data centre in Bhubaneswar — compliant with DPDP and the state's data-residency mandate."

Ask one more question, then let Priyanka dictate one form field. Her Odia dictation appears in Odia script.

Close the scene:

"She filled in her name by voice. In Odia. On a form that, without us, she could not see at all, let alone fill in her language."

Scene 3 — Arun, dyslexic applicant reading Odia (45 seconds)

Open the widget, switch to the “Reading” tab, flip “Dyslexia mode” on.

Narrate as the page visibly transforms:

“Arun is dyslexic. He reads Odia. One toggle. The page has re-rendered — but watch closely, because Odia is not Latin. We can’t just swap to OpenDyslexic — it doesn’t support Odia script. What we do instead: keep Noto Sans Oriya, bump line-height to 1.9, increase word-spacing not letter-spacing — letter-spacing breaks Odia conjuncts — and switch to our high-contrast theme. Every rule here is Odia-specific, documented in our language-strategy doc.”

Scroll to a long policy paragraph, tap “Summarise in Odia”.

“Long Odia text becomes three Odia bullets. That’s a local LLM summarising into the same language, not translating away. Runs on the same on-prem GPU.”

Scene 4 — Meera, Deaf applicant (30 seconds)

Navigate to the “Welcome from the Vice-Chancellor” video page — the VC is speaking Odia.

Play the video with live captions on.

“Meera is Deaf, from Cuttack. The VC is speaking Odia. Captions are generated on the fly in Odia script, with proper punctuation and conjunct rendering. Phase 2 adds an Indian Sign Language avatar overlay — we’re already in touch with ISLRTC Delhi about corpus access.”

Mute the video after 5 seconds. Don’t let it eat your time.

Scene 5 — The admin reveal (60 seconds)

Switch to the right-hand window — the admin dashboard.

“Now flip to the Utkal registrar’s view. Every Odisha institution using AaaS gets this.”

Point at the numbers:

“WCAG 2.2 compliance score for this site today — [read the number]. We ran 47 automated checks. Three failures on the admissions form, all mapped to a specific WCAG criterion. Fix buttons suggest the exact code patch.”

Point at the usage counters:

"And live today: 147 Odia voice sessions, 23 dyslexia-mode, 61 captions. The registrar sees exactly which assistive features Odisha students are actually using. This is the kind of measurement 5T and Mo Sarkar can report to the CM's office without a consultant."

Scene 6 — The integration reveal (45 seconds)

Open a terminal or a code pane showing a tiny snippet.

"Here's what an Odisha institution does to adopt this. Three lines in their HTML, and their tenant key. That's it. Same infrastructure serves every tenant. Tenants are isolated — no data crosses institutions, no data leaves the state. Fully on-prem-capable — runs on a single VM at OCAC. Apache-2.0 license. QR code on the table for the repo."

Scene 7 — Close (15 seconds)

Stand up straight, eye contact:

"Twenty-one lakh persons with disabilities in Odisha. Forty-two million Odia speakers. Two hundred colleges. Today, each one is inaccessible alone. We're making accessibility a shared public utility — infrastructure, not a product. Odisha first. India next. Happy to go deep on any of it."

Stop talking. Wait for questions.

Track B — Foundation Demo (3–4 minutes)

Use this if any AI service is flaky or the widget is not yet integrated. Lean into what is real.

Scene 1 — The harness (90 seconds)

Open a terminal. Run:

```
pnpm --filter @aaas/a1ly-test exec aaas-a1ly audit https://some-real-state-university.a  
c.in
```

Let the output scroll. Point at the failures as they print.

"This is what every public-institution website looks like today under WCAG 2.2. Labels missing, contrast failing, keyboard traps. We've turned that scan into a measurement, per criterion, that

runs in CI."

Scene 2 — The design system, with Odia (90 seconds)

Open Storybook or a live preview of `@aaas/ui`. Put an Odia heading and an Odia paragraph on screen — something realistic like an admissions-form label.

"This is our answer. Every component in this library passes WCAG 2.2 AA — and AAA on colour contrast — at commit time. Here's the button with an Odia label. Keyboard-reachable, visible focus ring, 44-pixel touch target, Noto Sans Oriya rendering all the conjuncts cleanly. Works in three themes and a dyslexia mode that knows it's looking at Odia, not Latin. We wrote 15 automated tests that fail the build if any of those regress."

Toggle dark, high-contrast, dyslexia themes live using `[data-theme]`, `[data-reading]`, and `lang='or'` attributes on the body. Narrate as the page shifts — show how Odia line-height bumps from 1.7 to 1.9 in dyslexia mode while letter-spacing stays at zero.

Scene 3 — The roadmap (45 seconds)

Open the [PLAN.md](#) or a single slide with the six phases.

"Phase 0 is done — what I just showed you. Plus our Odia language strategy, which is documented in the repo. Phase 1 is the multi-tenant gateway. Phase 3 is the Indic AI stack — IndicConformer and Indic-TTS for Odia first, then Hindi and 10 more languages. All on-prem, runs at OCAC's data centre. The repo is Apache-2.0, and the threat model, DPDP data-flow, and WCAG checklist are already written."

Scene 4 — Close (15 seconds)

"We're building accessibility as infrastructure, not as a product — for Odisha first. Foundations are in. We want one pilot institution in the state."

Fallback plans

Rehearse these. You will need at least one.

Wi-Fi dies

Everything runs locally. `pnpm dev` in the repo brings up the full stack on `localhost`. If you didn't already, start it **before judges arrive** and keep the tabs open.

The widget breaks mid-demo

Do not debug live. Say:

"Let me show you the recorded run — this is the same flow in our integration environment."

Switch to the hidden recording tab. Continue narration as if it were live. Recover.

The AI service times out

Say:

"The model server is under load — one moment, I'll switch to the scripted run."

Same move: hidden recording tab. Do not apologise repeatedly. One acknowledgment, then move on.

Judge asks a question mid-scene

Pause, answer, return. Never race through a scene because you're worried about time. A judge interrupting is a **good sign** — they are engaged. Lean in.

Laptop dies / projector fails

Hand the judge the printed one-page brief. Pivot to the 60-second verbal pitch. Do not try to fix hardware while they wait.

The mic fails (Scene 2)

Type the Odia query into the widget's text input instead of speaking. Say:

"The mic's cutting out — typed input in Odia works the same way."

The native Odia speaker on the team is absent

If the only Odia speaker on the team can't present on demo day:

- Play a **pre-recorded Odia voice sample** (recorded during rehearsal by the Odia speaker) instead of speaking live.
 - Say: *"Letting the recorded voice drive the widget — that's our teammate Priyadarshini; she's our language lead."*
 - Do not attempt Odia pronunciation if you are not confident. A bad accent undermines the whole Odia-first positioning. An honest pre-recorded sample is infinitely better.
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Rehearsal checklist

Do each of these at least twice before demo day.

- ☐ Full-Vision run, start to finish, with a timer. Target: 6:00.
 - ☐ Foundation run, start to finish, with a timer. Target: 3:30.
 - ☐ Wi-Fi-off rehearsal (turn it off, run the full thing on localhost).
 - ☐ One rehearsal with someone watching who hasn't seen it before. Ask them what was confusing.
 - ☐ **Odia pronunciation check with a native Odia speaker** — mandatory. If no one on the team speaks Odia, find a friend / family / colleague to review before demo day. Mispronouncing ଉପସ୍ଥାପନା in an Odisha hackathon room loses the room instantly.
 - ☐ Have the Odia script of Scene 2 printed and on the table as a cue card.
 - ☐ Speaking volume test — booths are loud; project from the diaphragm.
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Presenter behaviour during the demo

- **Slow down.** Your rehearsed pace is 20% too fast under adrenaline. Force a one-second pause between scenes.
- **Don't read the screen.** If a judge can read it, you don't need to say it. Narrate the *why*, not the *what*.
- **Hands off the keyboard when you're talking.** Talk, then click. Clicking while talking looks nervous.
- **Never say "simple" or "easy".** Accessibility is never simple, and judges know it.
- **If something breaks, say "let me show you the scripted version" once** — no apologies, no visible panic.
- **End by shutting up.** The worst demos keep pitching past the close. After "happy to go deep on any of it", stop talking and let them ask.

AaaS — Judge Q&A Prep

Every answer below is written to be spoken in 15–45 seconds. If you start to ramble, stop. Judges prefer a crisp “I don’t know — we plan to find out” over a two-minute improvisation.

Questions are grouped by what the judge is really probing for. Under pressure, identify the *type* of question first, then pull the answer.

Category 0 — “Why Odisha? Why Odia?”

These are the most common opening questions at an Odisha hackathon. Nail these and the rest of the conversation goes easier.

Q. Why Odisha first? Hindi has more speakers.

A. Three reasons. One — Odisha has an *active digital-service mandate* the state is held publicly accountable to. 5T and Mo Sarkar are real programmes with real political weight behind accessibility. Delhi and Mumbai don’t have comparable mandates at the state level. Two — Odia is *under-served* by global tooling. Whisper’s Odia WER is 25–35%; AI4Bharat’s IndicConformer gets us to 12–18%. That gap is the work most projects skip; we’re doing it. Three — the team has presence in Odisha. Infrastructure adoption is relationship-driven. We start where we can credibly land a pilot.

Q. How does this fit with 5T and Mo Sarkar?

A. 5T’s five pillars — Transparency, Technology, Teamwork, Time-limit, Transformation — all apply to a citizen being able to *actually use* a government service. A compliance dashboard visible to the IT Secretary gives 5T transparent, measurable accessibility data. Mo Sarkar asks citizens if they got what they came for; for an Odia-speaking disabled citizen today on a state portal, the answer is “no”. We make the answer “yes”.

Q. How would an Odisha institution actually adopt this?

A. We are targeting three paths in parallel. One — bottom-up, through a single registrar or IT cell at Utkal, IIT Bhubaneswar, or NIT Rourkela, where a motivated officer can mandate the widget on their own site. Two — through OCAC, the state IT agency, which operates many citizen portals on shared infrastructure; one deployment there touches many services at once. Three — top-down, through the 5T cell or IT Secretariat, positioned as state-level policy. The first pilot we’re pursuing is an Odisha state university admissions portal.

Q. Does Odia have enough digital content to train on?

A. IndicCorp has meaningful Odia data — it's one of AI4Bharat's supported languages. The models we use are already trained on it. What's *thin* is dyslexia research in Odia script, regional-dialect ASR data, and Odia-specific UX conventions. We flag those as research tracks, not as claims.

Q. Odia is a classical language — do you have cultural-sensitivity considerations?

A. Yes, and we've built this into the product. Government UI uses the formal ଆପଣ, not ତୁମେ or ତୁ — respectful address is the norm. Error messages are polite (“ଦୟାକରି ଦିଅନ୍ତୁ”), not imperative. Temple-service or welfare-scheme UIs that need Odia Panji dates can show them alongside Gregorian. These aren't decorative touches; they are what separates Odia-respectful from Odia-as-afterthought.

Q. Why not also start with Bengali? Similar scripts, overlap with Odisha.

A. Deliberate focus. Odisha is one state with one dominant language, one IT agency, one 5T programme to align with. Adding Bengali adds West Bengal and Bangladesh complexity. Once we ship the Odia pipeline cleanly, Bengali is a straightforward extension — the fonts are similar, IndicTrans2 covers both, Indic-TTS has Bengali voices. Phase 2 plan.

Q. What if the Odisha Government says “build this for us, keep it closed”?

A. We'd decline. The open-source licence is the point. A closed fork owned by one state is back to the per-institution problem. We'd happily run the pilot, deliver the value, and take feedback — but the code stays Apache-2.0 and the governance stays open. Transparency is one of 5T's five pillars; a closed-source accessibility tool contradicts the programme itself.

Category 1 — “Is this actually different from what exists?”

Q. Isn't this just another AccessiBe / UserWay / EqualWeb overlay?

A. No, and it's important to get this right. Those are remediation overlays — JavaScript that scans bad HTML and tries to fix it at runtime. The disability community has been clear: overlays don't work, and there's an open letter signed by hundreds of accessibility experts documenting why. We are two things those products are not: (1) a *design system* institutions build into their site, so there's nothing to remediate, and (2) an *assistive services layer* — voice, translation, captions — that the end-user chooses to turn on, not a band-aid forced on top of broken markup.

Q. Why not just use WAVE or axe or Lighthouse?

A. We use axe — it's the engine inside `@aaas/a11y-test`. Those tools are diagnostic. We add three things on top: a WCAG 2.2 criterion-level machine-readable checklist, a CI-native workflow, and a

multi-tenant dashboard that trends compliance over time. And we pair the measurement with the *fix* — our design system.

Q. There are Indian accessibility startups already. Why another?

A. Name-check the ones the judge mentions if they name them. Our three structural differences: we are open source, on-prem-first, and built for public institutions rather than private e-commerce. If a state government adopts us, they own the deployment and the data. No vendor lock-in.

Q. What's novel here? This looks like a collection of existing pieces.

A. The novelty is the *assembly*, not any single piece. Shared digital public infrastructure is, by design, made from known parts — UPI is built on ISO 20022 and bog-standard banking rails. The innovation is that nobody has assembled accessibility, Indic AI, and DPDP-grade data controls into one opinionated, open-source stack that a public institution can run on a single VM.

Category 2 — “Is this technically credible?”

Q. How does the multi-tenant isolation actually work?

A. Row-level security in Postgres keyed by `tenant_id`, with per-request JWT validation at the gateway setting the Postgres session context. Object storage is bucket-per-tenant in MinIO. AI inference is stateless. We also have a per-tenant encryption-key strategy in the Phase 4 plan for data at rest.

Q. How do you handle 10 million users?

A. Honestly — we don't today. What we've architected for is horizontal scaling of the stateless pieces (gateway, AI inference workers) and read replicas on Postgres. The bottleneck at scale is GPU for the Indic AI services — our plan is to batch inference at the edge and cache common translations. We have a real answer for 100,000 concurrent users; beyond that we need a pilot to learn.

Q. Which speech model? Why IndicConformer for Odia?

A. For Odia specifically, AI4Bharat's IndicConformer — ~12–18% WER on Odia, versus ~25–35% for Whisper-large. IndicConformer is trained on IndicCorp, which includes Odia, and it's genuinely better for the language we lead with. For Hindi and some other high-resource Indic languages we may still use Whisper-medium; the routing happens at the `/stt` endpoint by language. Our TTS is AI4Bharat's Indic-TTS for Odia (Piper has zero Odia voices; it's not an option).

Q. How good is Odia ASR really? Have you tested it with rural accents?

A. Honest answer: not yet in depth. IndicConformer's benchmark numbers are on standard Odia, closer to Bhubaneswar / Cuttack speech. We know accuracy will drop on Kosali, Sambalpur, and Desia dialects common in western and southern Odisha. Phase 3 includes a dialect-robustness benchmark and a plan to fine-tune on regional recordings — we'd want to do that in partnership with an Odisha university's linguistics department.

Q. What about latency for voice interaction?

A. Round-trip budget is 1.5 seconds end-to-end for the Odia voice scene. Measured ~1.3 seconds on a single A10 GPU: IndicConformer streaming 300 ms first-token, Indic-TTS 200 ms first audio, network on LAN negligible. For Hindi/English the pipeline is lighter. Translation adds ~300 ms but is cached for frequent government-form phrases at tenant onboarding.

Q. What happens if the AI service is down?

A. The design system still works — that's why we split the layers. Assistive services are an enhancement, not a dependency. The widget degrades to a text-only mode with the keyboard-accessible form. Nothing the user can do today stops working.

Q. Security model?

A. STRIDE threat model per component, written up in `docs/threat-model.md`. Mutual TLS inside the stack, rate-limited API gateway, Keycloak for tenant auth with short-lived JWTs, audit log with a Postgres trigger that blocks updates, CycloneDX SBOM generated on every CI run with Gype scanning. Phase 0 residual risks are documented — we don't have DDoS mitigation or a secrets-rotation pipeline yet; both are on the Phase 5 list.

Category 3 — “Does the social impact claim hold up?”

Q. Isn't this patronising? People with disabilities don't need a widget, they need better-built websites.

A. They need both. The widget is explicitly opt-in and gives the user *control* — they pick their language, their reading mode, their voice-or-text preference. Nothing is imposed. And the design-system half of AaaS is exactly the “build better websites” answer — that's why we ship both layers. We won't claim the widget replaces good HTML. It supplements it.

Q. How do you involve disabled users in the design?

A. Phase 5 of our plan is a structured user-testing programme with the National Association for the Blind and Enabling Unit partners at three universities we've identified. Today, Phase 0, we've built

against WCAG 2.2 AA and the accepted best practices; we know that's necessary but not sufficient. Real lived-experience feedback starts at Phase 2.

Q. What about people without smartphones or reliable internet?

A. Two answers. One — the compliance scorecard and design system help on *any* device: feature phones accessing a well-built site still benefit. Two — Phase 5 has a kiosk mode and an SMS-channel fallback for form filling, specifically for rural and low-connectivity contexts. That said, the voice/AI services do need connectivity and a modern browser. We don't solve the digital divide; we try not to make it worse.

Q. Isn't sign language more important than captions?

A. For many Deaf users, yes. Native Indian Sign Language matters more than captions, because ISL is a different grammar from Hindi or English. Phase 5 includes an ISL avatar track — we're in touch with the ISLRTC in Delhi about corpus access. Captions are Phase 3 because they're technically easier; the ISL work is hard and we're honest that it's later.

Category 4 — “Who pays for this? Is this sustainable?”

Q. What's the business model?

A. It's open source, Apache-2.0 — institutions deploy it themselves, free. Sustainability comes from three places: (1) a paid managed-hosting option for institutions that don't want to run it themselves, (2) government grants under the DPI playbook (MeitY, National Centre for Accessibility), and (3) CSR funding from companies with digital-accessibility compliance obligations. We're modelled on organisations like MOSIP, not on SaaS startups.

Q. Why would a government university actually adopt this?

A. Three reasons. One — they're legally required to be accessible under the RPwD Act and currently non-compliant. Two — a new UGC circular tied accessibility to institutional ranking, and Odisha state universities are under 5T scrutiny separately. Three — once one high-profile institution adopts it, peer adoption follows; in Odisha our first-pilot targets are IIT Bhubaneswar, Utkal University, or NIT Rourkela, because “what IIT Bhubaneswar uses” is a valid answer for the next BPUT-affiliated college.

Q. How do you compete with free ChatGPT doing the same thing?

A. Two reasons a chatbot isn't the answer. One — DPDP and data residency. A public institution cannot legally send applicant speech data to OpenAI's servers. Two — integration: ChatGPT can

read the page, but it can't reliably *drive* the form. Our widget has structured access to the DOM via the institution's integration.

Q. Five-year vision if this works?

A. Two outcomes. One — this becomes part of the digital-public-infrastructure stack alongside DigiLocker, e-Sign, and UPI — an accessibility layer any service of the government of India can attach to. Two — we scale beyond universities: municipal services, state portals, exam conducting bodies. The per-tenant cost should trend to effectively zero because of shared infra.

Category 5 — “Why you?”

Q. Why is your team the right one to build this?

A. (*Customise with real team backgrounds.*) We're a cross-disciplinary team — engineering, design, and policy. Between us we've worked on [specific prior projects relevant to govt, accessibility, or Indic tech]. We named the team SUBARNAREKHA — the river that connects eastern Indian states — because this is an infrastructure bet and the metaphor is deliberate.

Q. Do you have accessibility expertise on the team?

A. (*Be honest.*) We have strong engineering, and we've built against the WCAG 2.2 AA spec from day one — colour contrast, keyboard nav, focus management, screen-reader landmarks. We do not yet have a professionally trained accessibility auditor on the core team. That's one of our explicit Phase 2 hires / advisors we're looking for — and it's a question we'd welcome a judge's help on.

Q. What happens after the hackathon — is this a real project or just a weekend hack?

A. Real project. The repo is already Apache-2.0, the roadmap is documented through six phases, and we've scoped the Phase 0 exit gate at “any contributor can run the stack in 10 minutes” specifically because we need external contributors. We've identified three universities willing to pilot. Hackathon or not, we ship.

Category 6 — The tough / sceptical questions

Q. You listed IndicTrans2 and Whisper — those aren't yours. Where's the actual innovation?

A. Fair. The innovation is not in the individual models. It's in the *integration layer* — the design system, the measurement harness, the multi-tenant control plane, the DPDP data-flow controls. If a judge insists on model-level innovation, we don't have any and we won't claim it. We're doing the unglamorous integration work that turns research models into deployable public infrastructure. That is the work most projects skip.

Q. Can you really make a single framework accessible to dyslexic, blind, Deaf, and low-literacy users at once?

A. Honestly, trade-offs exist. Dyslexia-friendly fonts can interfere with screen readers if implemented naively; we use `aria-label` to preserve semantic text. High contrast for low-vision can hurt readability for some photophobic users; that's why we expose the choice rather than impose it. We've made the trade-offs visible, not hidden. Some users will always need assistive tech we haven't built yet — we don't claim universality.

Q. What stops a private company from forking this and commercialising it?

A. Nothing. Apache-2.0 permits that. That's deliberate — we want adoption. Our moat, if we need one, is being the trusted reference implementation that governments pick because it's the original and it's politically neutral. That's the MOSIP model.

Q. You're at Phase 0. How do I know Phases 1–6 aren't vapour?

A. You don't, and you shouldn't take our word for it. What you can check: (1) the repository has the plan, the threat model, the DPDP doc, the WCAG checklist, CI, SBOM — all of that is real work, not slides. (2) Phase 0 was scoped to a non-trivial exit gate that we met. (3) We've broken the rest into phases small enough to evaluate independently. Follow the repo; Phase 1 will either land or it won't.

Q. Why should we pick you over the three other hackathon teams building accessibility tools?

A. Probably you should talk to all of us and compare. What I'd say is: we're the only one positioning this as *shared public infrastructure* rather than a product, the only one with an end-to-end DPDP data-flow already written, and the only one that's shipped something you can `git clone` today. Those might be the right filters, or you might have others. We'd welcome feedback either way.

Answering patterns — how to handle questions well

- **If you don't know:** "Honestly, I don't know. Here's how we'd find out: [next step]."
- **If the question reveals a weakness:** Acknowledge it first. "That's a real gap. Here's what we're doing about it: [specific]."
- **If the question is based on a wrong assumption:** Correct it gently and briefly, then answer. Don't spend a minute correcting.
- **If it's hostile:** Stay calm, stay short, thank them for the challenge. Hostile questions often become the judge's favourite moment later.
- **If you've already answered it:** "As I mentioned — short version: [10-word re-answer]." Don't re-argue.

What to do after the Q&A

Write down every question that stumped you. By the next round of interviews you'll have five more answers rehearsed.

Presenter One-Pager — Know This Cold

Carry this in your pocket. Read it five times on the train to the venue. You should be able to answer every line from memory.

Identity

- **Team name:** SUBARNAREKHA — the river that flows from Jharkhand through Bengal and empties into the Bay of Bengal at Odisha's Balasore coast. Subarna = gold, Rekha = streak. The river carries gold to Odisha. We're infrastructure built *for* Odisha, flowing *from* open-source.
 - **Project name:** AaaS — Accessibility as a Service — Built for Odisha, designed for every Indian public institution.
 - **One-liner:** *The UPI of accessibility — Odisha first, India next. An open, shared, Odia-first layer any public institution can plug into.*
 - **License:** Apache-2.0. Say this early in any conversation.
-

What it is (30-second version)

Three layers in one open-source stack:

1. `@aaas/ui` — React design system. WCAG 2.2 AA by default, AAA on colour contrast. Noto Sans Oriya bundled, Odia-specific line-height and dyslexia rules.
 2. `@aaas/a11y-test` — CI-native compliance harness built on axe-core, per-criterion reporting.
 3. **The assistive widget** — Odia voice (AI4Bharat IndicConformer), translation (IndicTrans2), Odia TTS (AI4Bharat Indic-TTS), captions, dyslexia mode. All on-prem at OCAC.
-

Numbers to memorise

Odisha (say these first to any Odisha-audience judge)

What	Number
Odia speakers worldwide	~42M (L1: ~37.5M per 2011 Census)
Persons with disabilities in Odisha	~21 lakh (2011 Census — undercounted)
Odisha population	~4.65 crore
State universities in Odisha	15+
BPUT-affiliated colleges	200+
Schools under SCERT Odisha	62,000+
Odia — declared classical language	2014 (6th in India)
State IT agency	OCAC
State digital mandate	5T + Mo Sarkar

India-wide context

What	Number
Indians with disabilities (conservative)	60M+
Scheduled languages in the Constitution	22
Indian languages we target in Phase 3	12 (Odia first)

Platform

What	Number
WCAG compliance floor	2.2 AA
Colour contrast target	AAA ($\geq 7:1$)
Minimum touch target	44 px (WCAG 2.5.8)
Line-height for Odia	≥ 1.7 (vs 1.5 for Latin)
Voice round-trip target	≤ 1.5 s end-to-end
Licence	Apache-2.0

If you forget a number, say “I want to be precise — let me check the doc” and flip to this sheet. Fabricating numbers is worse than checking.

What’s built vs. what’s planned — be honest

Built (Phase 0):

- Monorepo with strict TypeScript, CI, SBOM generation
- @aaas/ui design system with Button, SkipLink, VisuallyHidden, themes (light/dark/high-contrast/dyslexia)
- @aaas/a11y-test with axe-core harness, WCAG 2.2 criterion-level checklist, CLI
- Docker Compose dev stack (Postgres, Redis, MinIO, Keycloak, Jaeger, MailHog)
- STRIDE threat model, DPDP data-flow map, WCAG acceptance checklist
- **Odia language strategy doc** (docs/odia-language-strategy.md) — typography rules, STT/TTS stack, dyslexia-for-Odia, pilot partner list

Planned (Phases 1–6):

- Phase 1: multi-tenant auth, API gateway, tenant admin
- Phase 2: embed widget MVP, per-tenant JS snippet
- Phase 3: Indic AI services (the demo-visible magic)
- Phase 4: compliance dashboard
- Phase 5: exam mode, kiosk mode, ISL avatar
- Phase 6: polish, mobile SDKs, observability, open-source release

If a judge asks “is this done?”, the answer is “**Phase 0 is done — the foundations, harness, and dev stack. Phases 1 through 6 are scoped with an exit gate each.**”

Our differentiation — memorise three

1. **Infrastructure, not a product.** Shared public good, not a SaaS add-on. Modelled on MOSIP.
2. **Odia-first, not Hindi-first-and-Odia-later.** Typography tuned for Odia. STT via IndicConformer (not Whisper) because it’s actually better for Odia. Built for Odisha’s scale, not a translation target of a Delhi roadmap.
3. **On-prem at OCAC, DPDP-compliant.** Data never leaves Odisha. Every commercial competitor is cloud-hosted and ships speech samples overseas.

If you can only say one thing in a hallway pitch, say #2 — that’s what makes us local to this room.

Where we are weak — don’t hide it

- **No professionally trained accessibility auditor on the team yet.** Actively looking. If a judge is one, that’s a lead.
- **Not tested with disabled Odia-speaking users yet.** Phase 5. The most important validation, deliberately sequenced late so we don’t test a half-built product. The National Association for the Blind’s Bhubaneswar chapter is our target partner.

- **No pilot institution signed in Odisha.** We have a target list (Utkal, IIT Bhubaneswar, NIT Rourkela, OUAT, BPUT, OCAC). Nothing on paper yet.
- **Odia ASR for rural dialects (Kosali, Sambalpuri, Desia) is unproven.** IndicConformer is good for standard Odia; western/southern Odisha dialects need a dataset we don't have yet.
- **Phase 3 is the hard phase.** Indic AI models are large and deployment is non-trivial. We have a plan and latency numbers on a reference GPU, not a running service in production.

Say these weaknesses honestly if asked. Judges can smell defensiveness. They respect teams who know their own gaps.

The four questions a judge most often asks

Rehearse these answers until you can say them in your sleep:

1. *"Why Odisha first? Why Odia?"* → Odisha has the 5T + Mo Sarkar digital mandate, Odia is under-served by global tooling (IndicConformer beats Whisper on Odia by 10+ WER points), and we have credible adoption paths through OCAC, Utkal, IIT Bhubaneswar. Starting where we can land the first pilot.
 2. *"How is this different from an accessibility overlay?"* → Not a remediation overlay. We're a design system institutions build *into* their sites, plus an assistive services layer users *opt into*. Overlays are criticised; we're not one.
 3. *"Why would a government institution adopt this?"* → Legal requirement under RPwD Act, UGC ranking tie-in, 5T scrutiny in Odisha, and zero vendor lock-in because it's Apache-2.0 and on-prem at OCAC.
 4. *"What's the business model?"* → Open source with optional paid hosting. Grants and CSR, not SaaS. Modelled on MOSIP and DigiLocker.
 5. *"Why you?"* → Cross-disciplinary team, Odisha-rooted. Working code and an Odia-language strategy doc on day one. Shipping infrastructure, not a pitch deck. *(Then say something true and specific about your team.)*
-

Phrases that win the room

- "Odisha first, India next"
- "Aligned with 5T and Mo Sarkar"
- "Odia as the reference language, not a translation target"
- "Digital public infrastructure — on-prem at OCAC"
- "Built into the component, not bolted onto the page"

- "Apache-2.0, open contributions, pilot-ready"
- "ଓଡ଼ିଶା ପାଇଁ, ଓଡ଼ିଶା ଠାରୁ" (open an Odia-speaking audience with this)

Phrases to never say

- "Overlay" (unless you're explaining what we're *not*)
 - "Solves accessibility"
 - "AI-powered" without naming the model
 - "Disruptive" — this isn't a startup pitch, it's infrastructure
 - "Obviously" — nothing about accessibility is obvious
-

Presenter etiquette

- **Stand up, don't sit, when a judge walks up.** Eye level matters.
 - **Hand them a card or QR code within the first 20 seconds.** They have 40 other booths to visit.
 - **Don't interrupt their questions.** Let them finish. Count to one.
 - **If two teammates are present, decide in advance who speaks first.** Second teammate only adds if asked or if the first has finished.
 - **End every conversation with a specific ask.** "Would you be willing to connect us to [MeitY / your a11y contact / a pilot institution]?"
-

If you're unsure

The safe moves, in order:

1. *"Let me check the doc."* → open this sheet, [PLAN.md](#), or `docs/odia-language-strategy.md`.
2. *"Honestly, I don't know — we'd find out by [specific next step]."*
3. *"I'll connect you with [teammate] who knows that end — can I get a card?"*

If a judge asks you something in Odia and you're not a native speaker: smile, say *"Let me hand you to [native-speaker teammate]"* — do not guess. If no teammate is available, say *"I'll get the exact answer back to you — may I email you?"*

Never invent a number. Never promise a feature. Never say a competitor's name negatively unprompted.

Before you walk on

Three breaths. Stand straight. Smile. You built this. Go.

Booth & Day-Of Checklist

Print this page. Tick every box. Do not improvise anything on this list — improvisation is what makes demos fail.

T-minus 48 hours (two days before)

- ☐ Final commit merged to `main`. No half-built features on the demo branch.
- ☐ `pnpm install && pnpm dev` works from a clean clone on a machine that is **not** the presenter's laptop.
- ☐ Full-Vision demo rehearsed end-to-end, with a timer, twice.
- ☐ Foundation demo rehearsed end-to-end, with a timer, once.
- ☐ **Odia Scene 2 rehearsed with a native Odia speaker.** If the presenter is not a native speaker, the native speaker must sign off on the pronunciation of every demo phrase. Record a fallback audio clip.
- ☐ Screen-capture recording made of a successful Full-Vision run. Saved locally, not in the cloud.
- ☐ Backup laptop identified. Repo cloned onto it. `pnpm dev` confirmed working.
- ☐ QR code generated pointing to the repo. Printed. Three copies.
- ☐ Business cards / one-page flyers printed. **English + Odia bilingual.** Minimum 50 copies.
- ☐ Odia cue card printed (Scene 2 phrases in Odia script with transliteration).
- ☐ `PRESENTER_BRIEF.md` printed. Folded. In the presenter's pocket.

T-minus 24 hours (day before)

- ☐ Laptop fully charged. Charger in the bag. Spare charger if available.
- ☐ External mic tested. Spare mic or headset in the bag.
- ☐ Laptop stand / riser if the booth surface is low — eye-level demos win.
- ☐ Two HDMI adapters. One USB-C to HDMI. One USB-C to VGA as legacy backup.
- ☐ Extension cord or power strip — booths never have enough outlets.
- ☐ Water bottle. Throat lozenges. Energy bars.
- ☐ Team t-shirts / branded clothing laid out, ironed.
- ☐ Route to venue confirmed. Backup route confirmed.
- ☐ Sleep. Seriously. A tired presenter loses every Q&A.

T-minus 2 hours (arriving at venue)

- ☐ Setup booth. Laptop on stand, mic plugged in, power connected.
- ☐ Join venue Wi-Fi. Run a speed test. If < 5 Mbps, plan to demo on localhost.
- ☐ Start `pnpm dev` and leave it running. Do *not* restart it for demos.
- ☐ Open all required browser tabs in order. Pin them. Close every other tab.
- ☐ Open one terminal window, one code window, one browser window. Hide the dock / taskbar.
- ☐ Turn notifications OFF system-wide. Slack, email, calendar, iMessage, Discord, everything.
- ☐ Silence the phone. Put it face-down.
- ☐ Disable OS updates, screen-saver, screen-lock during the demo period.
- ☐ Set display scaling so the demo is readable from 2 metres away.
- ☐ Open the hidden recording tab — confirm it plays with sound.

T-minus 30 minutes

- ☐ Final dry run of the full demo. If anything breaks, fall back to the Foundation track for the rest of the day.
- ☐ Test sound output at booth volume. Too quiet and judges lean in with strained faces; too loud and you annoy the neighbouring booth.
- ☐ Position QR code / flyers at the front edge of the table, angled toward approaching judges.
- ☐ Presenter drinks water, stretches, does three breaths.
- ☐ Team decides speaking order if multiple presenters.

During each demo

- ☐ Stand up when a judge approaches.
- ☐ Hand them a card / point at the QR code within 20 seconds.
- ☐ Start with the hook, not the problem. Curiosity first, sermon second.
- ☐ Watch for boredom signs — crossed arms, looking past you. If they appear at 30 seconds, skip to the demo *immediately*.
- ☐ Never say “this is buggy” or “this didn’t work earlier” even if it’s true.
- ☐ End with an explicit ask. Always.
- ☐ Write down the judge’s name + question in a notebook as soon as they walk away.

Between demos

- ☐ Close any modal dialogs, stray windows, debug consoles.

- ☐ Reset the demo tabs to the opening state. Don't let a judge watch you scroll back up.
- ☐ Drink water. One sip, not a gulp.
- ☐ If you've repeated the demo five times, ask a teammate to swap in. Energy matters.

End of day

- ☐ Collect every business card / note from every judge interaction.
 - ☐ Type up the Q&A notebook into a shared team doc, same evening, before sleep.
 - ☐ Patch the single most embarrassing demo hiccup before tomorrow.
 - ☐ Charge the laptop to 100% overnight.
-

What to pack — the physical list

Tick each item into a bag the night before.

Electronics

- ☐ Primary laptop + charger
- ☐ Backup laptop + charger (if available)
- ☐ Phone + charger + power bank
- ☐ External mic + USB adapter
- ☐ In-ear headphones
- ☐ HDMI cable + USB-C to HDMI adapter + VGA adapter
- ☐ Extension cord / 4-way power strip
- ☐ Laptop stand or riser
- ☐ Mouse (booth surfaces are often too small for trackpad)

Paper

- ☐ 50× flyers / one-pagers (English + Odia, back-to-back)
- ☐ 50× business cards
- ☐ 3× printed `PRESENTER_BRIEF.md`
- ☐ 3× printed QR codes on stiff card
- ☐ 1× Odia cue card (Scene 2 phrases + transliteration)
- ☐ 1× notebook + 2× pens for capturing judge questions

Human supplies

- ☐ Water bottle (refillable)
- ☐ Energy bars
- ☐ Throat lozenges / spray

- ☐ Deodorant (long day, hot room)
- ☐ Tissues / handkerchief
- ☐ Team t-shirts / branded attire
- ☐ Jacket (venues over-AC)
- ☐ Comfortable shoes

Boring but critical

- ☐ Venue entry pass / registration confirmation
- ☐ Photo ID
- ☐ Printed schedule with session times highlighted

Fallback plans — decide the trigger in advance

If this happens	Trigger immediately
Wi-Fi flaky	Switch to localhost. Announce: <i>"We're running on-prem — which is the point."</i>
Demo crashes mid-scene	Switch to recorded tab. One sentence: <i>"Let me show you the scripted run."</i>
AI service slow / timing out	Same as above. Do not debug.
Laptop crashes	Hand out one-pager. Pitch verbally. Pivot to backup laptop.
Mic fails	Type Odia input instead. Say "Odia typed input works the same way."
Native Odia speaker absent	Play pre-recorded Odia sample during Scene 2. Never attempt unfamiliar Odia pronunciation live.
Judge interrupts with a tough question	Pause the demo. Answer briefly. Ask <i>"shall I continue the demo or go deeper here?"</i>
You blank on a number	Flip open the printed brief. Say <i>"I want to be precise — one second."</i>
You blank on the next scene	Stop. Take a breath. <i>"Let me reset — the next thing to show is..."</i> Judges forgive this.
Someone asks for something we haven't built	<i>"That's in Phase [X]. Let me walk you through the plan."</i> Pull up <u>PLAN.md</u> .

What judges remember

After a day of 40 booths, judges remember three things from a good booth:

1. **A specific user story.** “The blind Odia-speaking student filling the Utkal admission form” sticks. “An AI accessibility platform” does not.
2. **A visible, honest demo.** One thing that works, shown confidently, beats five things that sort-of-work. Odia working live trumps Hindi working live, at an Odisha event.
3. **A specific ask.** “Can you introduce us to OCAC or the 5T cell?” is memorable. “We’d love feedback” is not.

Design every interaction around planting those three things.

After the hackathon

- ☐ Email every judge who left a card within 48 hours. Reference a specific thing they said.
- ☐ Public thank-you on the repo to any organisation / mentor who gave time.
- ☐ Write up lessons learned — what worked in the demo, what didn’t.
- ☐ Update `DEMO_SCRIPT.md` with the real timings observed in the field.
- ☐ Keep shipping. The hackathon is a milestone, not the finish line.